

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption Leader, Workforce Transformation, Hands-On Builder

Three-time TIAA Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026) and 2025 "Face of TIAA" Values VIP (Top 4 of 16,000 Associates)

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16,000+

ASSOCIATES GIVEN ACCESS TO
THE AI PLATFORM I CONCEIVED
AND LAUNCHED

1,500+

REACHED DIRECTLY ACROSS 30+
EVENTS

7

BUSINESS AREAS ON ONE
OPERATING FRAMEWORK

2

INDEPENDENT AI PRODUCTS,
LIVE IN PRODUCTION

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

I am technically fluent enough to scope a problem, tell a good technical answer from a bad one, and direct a build to the finish. I am not the engineer. The AI products I have shipped are the proof I do not need to be.

I close the gap between AI investment and real workforce change. At TIAA (Fortune 100, \$1.6T AUM) I conceived and launched CareerSpark, a 9-module AI capability platform rolled out to 16,000+ associates, and I owned it from the first discovery conversation through governance, deployment, and measured use. I built the operating framework that connected seven Client Services business areas, and I led workplace modernization for 3,000+ associates across six locations. Before TIAA, ten years at Pearson and Vangent as a sales engineer, information architect, and knowledge engineer, sitting between Fortune 500 clients and the teams that built what they bought. My M.S. in Instructional Technology grounds the adoption work in design rather than opinion.

INDEPENDENT AI PRODUCTS CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

The reason I can sit with an engineering team, judge the trade-offs, and keep a decision moving without pretending to be the engineer.

- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live in production:** I conceived the product, designed the 5-stage discovery framework, modeled the career data across 922 paths, and directed the build on Next.js, the Vercel AI SDK, and multi-provider AI. My brother is the primary engineer. I own the product decisions and stay close enough to the technology to judge what is worth building and what is not.
- **CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), live:** I conceived the product and designed the 11-module journey, the multi-agent AI interview simulator, the applicant CRM, and the employer-personalized portfolio delivery. I directed the build on Next.js and Stripe and write production code by directing AI tooling. My brother is the primary engineer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA (Fortune 100 Financial Services, \$1.6T AUM | 16,000 Associates)

Business Manager (2016-2022) | Sr. Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Led enterprise initiatives across the Client Services organization (~3,000 associates). Led the associate-transformation workstream of TIAA's Recordkeeping Transformation program. Partnered across HR, Workplace Services, Facilities, Risk and Compliance, and IT.

AI Adoption, Governance, and Measured Impact

- **Took an AI platform from idea to embedded use across the enterprise (2024-2025):** Conceived, designed, and launched CareerSpark, a 9-module AI capability platform rolled out to 16,000+ associates. Owned every stage, from discovery and use-case scoping through governance, deployment, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. Ran 30+ townhalls and events that reached 1,500+ associates directly.

- **Cleared Risk, Compliance, and Legal without stalling the build:** Prototyped and pressure-tested the idea first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set hard limits once it was worth building. No associate data on company servers. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the associate in control of the decision.
- **Measured adoption by active usage, not headcount with access:** Defined the success measures for the AI capability work and reported the usage number to senior leaders. Access is the easy number. Usage is the one that tells a leader whether the investment worked.
- **Built and ran the Skills of the Future curriculum with a team of 7:** A separate capability program from CareerSpark. Designed 5 tracks of 12-17 modules each on future and digital-first skills for Client Services and other large associate populations. 890 associates engaged across 1,156 interactions.
- **Proved a faster delivery model inside the enterprise:** Built the CareerSpark Manager Guide on Amazon Q in one week against a months-long traditional path, then used it to show teams what AI-accelerated delivery actually looks like.

Operating Model, Investment Case, and Executive Engagement

- **Built one operating framework across seven business areas so good work scaled instead of being rebuilt:** Connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning across Workplace, Associate Engagement, and Rewards and Recognition. One approach run seven times, in place of seven approaches.
- **Made the case to senior leaders in language they could act on:** Built and delivered executive read-outs, townhalls, people-leader updates, and quarterly business reviews, carrying progress, trade-offs, and prioritization decisions to leaders who were not technical.
- **Evaluated vendors and selected an enterprise platform:** Earned a seat on TIAA's corporate selection team that chose the enterprise recognition platform, after growing the Client Services program 395% on a \$500K budget.

Change Delivery

- **Led workplace modernization for 3,000+ associates across six locations (2022-2024):** Owned change strategy through return-to-office, the Denver consolidation (44% real estate footprint reduction, 700+ associates moved to hoteling), and the Frisco Corporate Center opening for 500+ associates. Recognized as Change Champion.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

2000 - 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital

Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions, serving Fortune 500 enterprises and federal agencies.

- **Sat between the client's business problem and the team that had to build it, for ten years:** Worked directly with Fortune 500 clients (Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, Regions Bank) to scope capability needs, design adoption approaches, and shape multi-year implementation plans across business, technology, and end-user audiences.
- **Carried the technical answer into the room without being the developer:** Served as sales engineer, knowledge engineer, information architect, and instructional designer across enterprise LCMS and ATS platforms. Field-driven ATS enhancements helped clients cut hiring costs 50-80% and cut speed-to-hire in half.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI & Transformation: AI Adoption Strategy | Use-Case Discovery & Prioritization | Responsible AI Governance | AI Enablement | Agentic AI & Multi-Agent Workflows | Daily builder across Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Kiro, GitHub Copilot

Operating Model & Delivery: Operating Framework Design | Business Case Development | Adoption & Impact Measurement | Change Management | Risk, Compliance & Legal Partnership | Budget Management (~\$500K)

Enterprise & Executive: Executive Read-Outs & Decision Forums | Cross-Functional Influence (HR, Technology, Business, Risk, Legal) | Workshop Design & Facilitation

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | **B.A. Art**, Millersville University, PA

Certifications: Google Generative AI for Leaders | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class)